

POLI SCI 490

Statistical Computing Workshop

2025-2026

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Overview

The Statistical Computing Workshop is a year-long series that meets three times per quarter during the academic year. The purpose of the workshop is to learn, practice, and update cutting edge statistical programming skills as they apply to quantitative and computational social science.

Workshop meetings will feature internal or external speakers introducing a new tool, method, approach, or practice. All meetings are hybrid or fully virtual.

The workshop is open to everyone. Graduate students in political science formally enrolled in the corresponding version of POLI_SCI 490 will receive full credit by attending to every meeting.

The aim is to present topics that are equally useful for new and advanced users. So if you see a topic that you are already confident on, chances are that you will still learn something new.

Schedule

Fall (2:00 – 3:15 PM, Scott Hall 212)

September 30: Gustavo Diaz (Northwestern University)

“Dos and Don’ts of Coding with AI”

October 21: Yuki Atsusaka (University of Houston)

“A Practical Guide to Ranking Data Analysis in the Social Sciences”

November 11: Alexander Coppock (Northwestern University)

“Declaring and Diagnosing Research Designs”

Winter (12:30 – 2:00 PM, Scott Hall 212)

January 20: Artur Baranov (Northwestern University)

“Hands-On Methods for Text-as-Data Research”

February 17: Andrew Heiss (Georgia State)

“Building reproducible workflows with {targets}”

February 24: Yingdan Lu (Northwestern University)

“Rethinking Computational Multimodal Analysis in Social Science Research”

Spring (12:30 – 2:00 PM)

April 15: Sameer Deshpande (University of Wisconsin-Madison)

Online only

“Estimating heterogeneous causal effects with varying coefficient models and Bayesian Additive Regression Trees”

April 22: Andrés Cruz (University of Texas at Austin)

“Leveraging Python and JAX in R workflows”

May 13: Adeline Lo (University of Wisconsin-Madison)

“A Statistical Model of Bipartite Networks: Application to Cosponsorship in the United States Senate”

Details Subject to Change

Please note that the specifics of this workshop are subject to change in the case of unforeseen circumstances.